

University of Michigan
Fall 2024 Midterm Instructor Report
EECS 110-001: Discover CS
Madelyn Gatchel

29 out of 46 students responded to this midterm evaluation.

Responses to questions related to the course:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
I am learning a great deal in this course. (Q966)	13	13	2	1	0	0	4.38

Responses to questions related to the instructor:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
Madelyn Gatchel is enthusiastic. (Q114)	20	9	0	0	0	0	4.78
Overall, this is an excellent course. (Q964)	17	9	2	1	0	0	4.65
Overall, Madelyn Gatchel is an excellent teacher. (Q965)	20	9	0	0	0	0	4.78
Madelyn Gatchel acknowledges all questions insofar as possible. (Q968)	20	9	0	0	0	0	4.78
Madelyn Gatchel uses techniques to foster class participation. (Q972)	19	8	2	0	0	0	4.74
Madelyn Gatchel is willing to meet and help students outside class. (Q975)	21	7	0	0	0	1	4.83
Madelyn Gatchel keeps students informed of their progress. (Q977)	14	12	2	0	0	1	4.50

Written Comments

What are the major strengths of this class? What is helping you to learn? (Q979)

Comments
I really enjoy the format of half lecture half lab. I also found office hours and the lecture notes extremely helpful.
Madelyn is awesome
I think the significant strengths of this class are the passion, enthusiasm, and support the instructors have for the topic and the students. They try their best to make sure students understand the topic and help through projects in an understanding way that I have yet to experience much before. Their support and passion for the subject helped me learn and not give up on this course. Also, what helps me learn is the number of resources they provide, including giving access to PowerPoint slides and practice problems to try. That helped me engage in the course in a way I can understand.
The labs and putting the concepts we learn into practice help me a lot. Working with other students to figure out how to write code is also very helpful as well. I also like the style of how this course is taught
I believe that the structure of this class works very well in teaching students the different parts of computer science. The slideshows and interactive class documents help to learn how to perform certain tasks in Python.
I think for the most part, if you are extremely new to coding, this class teaches you everything you would need to know for python. I love the fact that this teacher goes out of her way to help with the coding portion especially when most teachers in cs don't like to help within this aspect.
The instructors were very helpful
Learning how to code in basic steps. I like how the slides go step by step and the colab notebook for each lecture is very helpful for me to look back after class.
It gives people the ability to learn coding without any prior knowledge.
Group collaboration. Team building skills.
Very open to questions.
It is very organized, and instructors are very focused on keeping us engaged in learning. I am enjoying this course.
Being able to do practice during class and then having time at the end to work on lab/quiz.
This class has a lot of teamwork and student participation. The team homework and examples in class lectures all help me to learn.
It's a good introduction for people who have never taken CS. Unfortunately I am already versed in introductory Python so i'm not necessarily learning a whole lot.
I wanted a basic understanding of coding and think I gained that for python
Helping me to learn the basics of computer science.
simple but not too slow
Very helpful slides for Python, I have referred to the slides for Python refreshing.
First of all, I think this class is great, but I've encountered some issues with group projects. In several cases, one person who was more experienced with coding ended up doing all the work, while the rest of us learned nothing. I was told that the groups were designed to include only beginner-level coders, but how is it that one person was so much more advanced? I don't want to place the blame on more experience person, though, because we were given over an hour of work for the lab, but only had 20–30 minutes to complete it. I really appreciate the teaching style, but it might be helpful to go over more examples in class. We're being assigned large, challenging projects, but the material we're learning in class is still fairly basic. For future projects, it would be great if the groups could be more balanced, so that no one person ends up doing all the work. Also, it would be helpful if we had enough time to complete the lab assignments.
down to earth, very patient
The Lectures are really helpful, I appreciate being able to learn the basics one step at a time

How can Madelyn Gatchel improve this class? If possible, give specific examples. (Q980)

Comments
I think the class is excellent and I do not have any thoughts on how to improve the class. It is great for students with little to no programing experience.
N/A
I think making the assignments and labs a little more simpler for people who have zero coding experience can help. For example, on some of the labs, I can't assist my lab partners in the lab at times due to not understanding the material we just learned in class. If the lab or the practice problems were more similar to the lectures giving in class, I think it would be better to understand what to do and how to help when stuck. I do struggle with understanding the material and applying that to assignments, but I think if there was a balance between a challenge for experience coders, and easiness for inexperience coders, I think that the labs would go more smooth.
Maybe take it a little slow for those who doesn't know much about computer science. Sometimes it feels like I can't catch up and maybe give more examples per code or new point.
When trying to figure out a lab, she could maybe be a less little vague (however I know she doesn't want to give us the direct answer so this may be hard, sometimes I would jsut like a tad bit more "nudging")
I believe there is very little that Madelyn Gatchel could do to improve this class. She is incredibly enthusiastic and helpful with students, and the help that she provides is always insightful. Additionally, she is very accessible and approachable, making interactions much more easygoing.
She could introduce hints here and there for the assignments after a certain period during class. (i.e. writing some parts of code on the board to ease the transition to writing code independently.)
NA
Maybe have one separate google document or slides that covers all the concepts for easier reference to look back to the code.
This class is ran great.
N/A
I do not think there is any.
N/A
Overall I think she does the class as it is described and designed. I wouldn't say there is much to be changed.
Same as the last one
Making the slides more interactive and engaging.
play kahoot games
Same as above.
N/A

Please enter any additional comments you have for Madelyn Gatchel. (Q981)

Comments
No
N/A
I enjoy having you as instructor because I can see the joy and excitement from you have when teaching this course and computer science in general. I'm thankful all the help and support you give the students and me in the course and I wish you luck on your journey on becoming a professor.
N/A
NA
N/A
N/A
N/A
N/A
None
None
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thank you